

Festivals and celebrations



Teacher's Pack

Me and my culture: festivals and celebrations

Contents

Festivals and celebrations: teachers' notes

Festivals and celebrations: classroom materials

Copyright - please read

All the materials on these pages are free for you to download and copy for educational use only. You may not redistribute, sell or place these materials on any other website without written permission from the British Council. If you have any questions about the use of these materials please email us at: esolnexus@britishcouncil.org

Introduction

Me and my culture will give your learner the language needed to talk about who he or she is and aspects of his or her culture. There are three units in this pack: **Nice to meet you**, **Festivals and Celebrations** (this pack) and **Food from around the world**. These nine lessons complement each other but can be used separately. Timings are approximate and depending on your learner may take more or less time than that shown.

This unit continues to work on building learner confidence and establishing a positive relationship between you and your learner. It introduces the months and seasons and the present simple tense in the context of talking about festivals and celebrations. Your learner will develop an awareness of a range of celebrations and also have the opportunity to talk about festivals and celebrations in his or her own country.

Overview

Unit 1: nice to meet you

- 1a. Asking about people
- 1b. Asking about things
- 1c. Asking about numbers

Unit 2: festivals and celebrations

- 2a. Let's celebrate
- 2b. Chinese New Year
- 2c. Party time

Unit 3: food from around the world

- 3a. What food do you like?
- 3b. Making a shopping list
- 3c. Typical food

Lesson 2a: Let's celebrate!**Time:** 60 minutes**Aims:**

- to introduce the topic of festivals and celebrations, months of the year and seasons.
- to develop your learner's awareness of present simple tense verbs in the first person (to describe habits)
- to introduce your learner to question formation.

Objectives:

Your learner will be able to:

- name the months of the year
- name the seasons
- name a range of celebrations and festivals
- form simple sentences about what he or she does on a special day
- ask simple yes/no and wh-questions.

Preparation

You will need:

- your own photographs of celebrations (birthday, Christmas, etc.) and/or **Worksheet 1**
- realia from different celebrations, for example: *crème egg, Christmas tree decoration, sparkler, candle from birthday cake, Halloween mask, Diwali lantern* etc. (If possible, find out about a celebration from your learner's country and bring an item associated with it).
- a calendar (preferably one with scenic seasonal pictures)
- **Worksheets 1 and 2**
- **Worksheet 3** (cut up and shuffled)
- **Worksheet 4** (sentences and pictures cut up and shuffled)
- a few large pieces of paper for writing down language (your learner can take this home with them).

Consider:

Before getting started on this unit, find out about celebrations in your learner's country. Download and print off pictures to support your learner in speaking activities. Find out a little about some of the most popular celebrations so you can provide your learner with the words he or she needs.

Be aware that, for some learners, festivals and celebrations might be an emotional topic which brings back memories of happy times with family in his or her homeland.

Introduction (5 mins)

- Lay the celebration realia out on the table. Encourage your learner to explore the items and name them in English.
- Focus your learner's attention on the title of the unit. Explain that you will be learning about festivals and celebrations together.
- Ask your learner if he or she knows the names of the festivals these items are associated with. Write down the names of the festivals and drill pronunciation.

Activity 1: talking about celebrations (10 mins)

- Show your learner your own photographs of a range of different celebrations. Alternatively, show your learner **Worksheet 1** (which has pictures of Christmas, a birthday and Halloween). Elicit the names of the celebrations.
- Encourage your learner to describe what he or she can see in the photographs. Elicit as much vocabulary as possible.
- Ask your learner which of the festivals he or she celebrates. Which does he or she know about? Encourage your learner to tell you about an important festival or celebration in his or her own country.

Activity 2: the seasons (10 mins)

- Focus your learner's attention on the photographs in **Worksheet 2**.
- Elicit the names of the four seasons and write them down, drilling pronunciation.
- Elicit what season it is now. Ask your learner what the weather is usually like in this season in the UK.
- For each season elicit a few simple weather phrases, for example: *'It's hot'*, *'it's cold'*, *'it's rainy'*, *'it's windy'*, *'it's snowy'*, *'it's sunny'* etc. Write these down (or ask your learner to write them down).
- Go through the seasons one by one. Ask your learner what the weather is usually like in this season in his or her country, for example: *'In summer it's hot and sunny'*.
- Encourage your learner to tell you which season he or she likes and does not like and give a reason.

Activity 3: months (10 mins)

- Choose a month on the calendar at random and elicit the season from your learner. If your learner is unfamiliar with the months, practise saying each one in turn using the calendar or **Worksheet 3** until he or she is more confident.
- Ask your learner to find the current month on the calendar. Ask the learner to tell you what month it is now. Drill pronunciation if necessary.
- Continuing to work with the calendar, ask your learner to tell you the name of next month, last month etc. Ask '*When is your birthday?*' '*When is Christmas?*' '*What months are summer in the UK?*'
- Give your learner **Worksheet 3** (months of the year cut up). Write the names of the seasons: *spring*, *summer*, *autumn* and *winter* in four columns on a piece of paper. Go through the pile of months with your learner. Ask him or her to group the months with the seasons. During the activity, encourage your learner to read the month aloud. Drill pronunciation where necessary.

Activity 4: talking about Christmas (15 mins)

- Show your learner the Christmas tree decoration you have brought in. Ask your learner which month and which season Christmas is celebrated in.
- Lay the pictures from **Worksheet 4** on the table and explain that all of the pictures show people celebrating Christmas. Elicit as much language as possible, for example: *turkey*, *church*, *children*, *game*, *tree*, *presents* etc. Alternatively, say the words and ask your learner to identify the photo they appear in.
- Ask your learner to read the sentences (or read the sentences and ask your learner to repeat after you). Next, encourage your learner to match the sentences with the correct picture. Once he or she has done this, read the sentences again and deal with any pronunciation issues.
- Underline the verbs in each sentence. Check learner's understanding of each one, by asking him or her to mime the meaning or by miming the meaning yourself.
- Put the sentences to one side. Choose photos at random, and ask your learner to remember the sentence.
- If you celebrate Christmas, choose the things which you do. Tell your learner how you celebrate Christmas. If you do not celebrate Christmas, tell your learner what the most important celebration of the year is for you. Tell your learner how you celebrate this festival, using some of the key verbs and vocabulary from **Worksheet 4** if at all possible.

Activity 5: asking questions about a celebration (10 mins)

- Ask your learner if he or she celebrates Christmas and if so, ask about the celebration. If not, ask your learner to tell you about an important celebration that he or she celebrates.
- Ask your learner questions about his or her festival or celebration, for example: *'When is this celebration?' 'What do you eat?' 'What do you drink?' 'What do you do?' 'Do you go to church/a mosque/a temple?' 'Do you stay at home?' 'Do you go out?' 'Where do you go?'*
- As you ask the questions, write them down. Elicit and clarify the meaning of *when*, *what* and *where* and highlight which questions require a *yes/no* answer.
- When your learner has finished talking about his or her celebration, focus attention on the questions you have written. Read them aloud, and ask your learner to repeat after you. Drill pronunciation, focusing on intonation.
- Think of a celebration which you enjoy (a different one from the one you spoke about in activity 4). Encourage your learner to ask you the prepared questions about it and give as much information as possible, using photographs to illustrate your answers if possible.

Learning check:

Monitor activity 5 to assess whether your learner is able to:

- Talk about months and seasons using appropriate vocabulary
- Ask questions about celebrations and festivals
- Describe festivals and celebrations

Cooler

- Revisit the realia from the warmer. Ask your learner what he or she remembers about the festivals and celebrations. Elicit the season/month when these celebrations occur.

Differentiation:

If your learner has coped very well with forming present simple sentences in the first person, try introducing adverbs of frequency, for example: *always, usually, sometimes, never*.

- Draw a line on a piece of paper with 100 per cent written at one end (to denote *always*) and zero per cent at the other (to denote *never*).
- Write the following sentence: *I celebrate Christmas*. Ask your learner to choose the adverb which best applies to him or her and elicit where it should go (before the verb).
- Ask your learner to speak again about the celebration he or she chose in activity 5. This time he or she should use adverbs of frequency.

Lesson 2b: Chinese New Year

Time: 60 minutes

Aims:

- to continue building vocabulary related to festivals and celebrations, in particular Chinese New Year
- to recap months and seasons vocabulary from the previous lesson
- to develop your learner's ability to use present simple in the third person singular. Please note, however, that while your learner may understand the use of the third person 's', it can take time for this particular grammar point to be applied consistently.

Objectives:

Your learner will be able to:

- Form simple sentences in the third person present simple, for example: '*he goes...*', '*he eats...*' (to describe what someone does at Chinese New Year)
- Ask simple *yes/no* and *wh*-questions in the third person present simple.

Preparation

You will need:

- calendar and celebration realia (from Lesson 2a)
- **Worksheet 5**
- **Worksheet 6** (pictures, questions and answers all cut up and shuffled)
- a photo of a friend or family member enjoying a favourite celebration (for Activity 4).

Consider:

This lesson focuses on Chinese New Year. If this is celebrated in the town or city where you live, try to find photographs of local festivities.

Introduction (5 mins)

- Begin to flick through the pages of the calendar. Ask your learner to look away from you and to say *'Stop!'* after a few seconds. When your learner says *'Stop!'* open the calendar.
- Elicit the month and the season. Ask your learner: *'What is the weather like in this month?'* *'Do you like this month?'* *'Do you know any festivals and/or celebrations which happen in this month?'* Repeat this activity a few times.

Activity 1: talking about Chinese New Year (5 mins)

- Focus your learner's attention on the photographs in **Worksheet 5**. Ask your learner to describe what he or she sees. Elicit as much language as you can.
- Ask your learner to read the sentences (or to read them after you).
- Ask your learner: *'What season is Chinese New Year?'* *'Do you celebrate Chinese New Year?'* Show your learner photos of local celebrations of this festival, if possible.

Activity 2: vocabulary (10 mins)

- Show your learner the Chinese New Year photos from **Worksheet 6**. Ask your learner to describe whichever photos he or she can.
- Teach your learner the words he or she does not know and drill pronunciation (for example: *dumplings, lanterns, decorations*, etc.)

Activity 3: present simple questions and answers (20 mins)

- Show the photos again, eliciting a word or two for each.
- Ask your learner to read the questions from **Worksheet 6** aloud (or read them aloud and ask your learner to repeat). Drill pronunciation, focusing on intonation.
- Ask your learner to match the questions with whichever pictures he or she thinks might provide the answer.
- Finally, ask your learner to read the answers aloud (or read the answers aloud with your learner). Ask your learner to match the answers with the photographs and the questions.
- Underline the verbs in each sentence. Elicit that the verbs have an *-s* at the end, because we are talking about the third person singular. Form a sentence in the first person, for example: *'I eat dumplings at Chinese New Year'* to demonstrate the contrast.

Festivals and celebrations: Chinese New Year – teachers' notes

- Read the questions from **Worksheet 6** to your learner, and elicit the answer before swapping roles. Move the questions and answers to one side. Using the pictures as prompts, ask your learner the same questions and elicit the answers. Swap roles and repeat the activity.
- Quickly cut up the questions into individual words. Ask your learner to put the words in the correct order to form questions. Ask your learner to read the questions.

Activity 4: talking about a family member (10 mins)

- Show your learner the picture of your friend or family member enjoying his or her favourite celebration.
- Introduce the family member (say what his or her name is, where he or she is from). Alternatively, encourage your learner to ask questions to find out this information.
- Elicit the name of the celebration. Ask your learner what he or she already knows about this celebration (when it is, what people do, eat etc).
- Tell your learner that he or she is going to make questions to find out what your friend or family member does on this day. The learner can use the four questions from activity 3 and think of his or her own questions too.
- Elicit the questions from your learner and write them down. Answer your learner, giving as much information as possible.

Cooler

- Ask your learner to think of a friend and/or family member who has a favourite celebration. Ask questions about what your learner's friend does on this special day. Gently prompt your learner to use the third person 's', if he or she forgets.

Learning check:

Monitor activity 4 and the cooler to assess whether your learner is able to ask questions and make sentences to describe a celebration using the third person accurately.

Extension:

- If you have the time, and you think your learner would enjoy it, consider adding a topic related craft activity onto the end of your lesson, for example: making a Chinese lantern. Such activities can generate a lot of very useful language and could also prove very relaxing for your learner.

Festivals and celebrations: Chinese New Year – teachers' notes

- You can find instructions on how to make a simple Chinese lantern here:
<http://www.enchantedlearning.com/crafts/chinesenewyear/lantern/>



Lesson 2c: party time!

Time: 60 minutes

Aims:

- to continue building vocabulary related to festivals and celebrations, in particular birthdays
- to recap months and seasons vocabulary from Lesson 2a
- to introduce ordinal numbers in the context of dates.

Objectives:

Your learner will be able to:

- say dates (using ordinal numbers)
- invite someone to a party orally and in writing
- write about his or her birthday (extension).

Preparation

You will need:

- one or two party invitations. If you don't have any to hand, write a couple of sample ones on colourful paper.
- realia from a birthday party: *candles, balloons, wrapping paper, birthday cards* etc.
- a calendar
- pictures of celebrations from the previous two lessons
- **Worksheet 7** Writing frame (preferably on colourful paper)
- **Worksheet 8** role play script

Introduction (5 mins)

- Show your learner the birthday realia and ask him or her to guess what celebration you will be discussing in this lesson. Elicit names for the items.
- Write the date and month of your birthday on the board. Read the date, asking your learner to repeat the ordinal number after you.
- Ask your learner to tell you his or her birthday. Write the date on the board, and drill pronunciation of the ordinal number.

Activity 1: introducing ordinal numbers (10 minutes)

- Write the following dates on the board: 25/12, 01/01, 31/10, and 05/11. Ask your learner to tell you the dates and months. Your learner may still use the non-ordinal number form. Highlight the fact that a different form is used with dates. Say the ordinal numbers and ask your learner to repeat after you. Highlight the use of the word *of* between the ordinal number and the month.
- Write down the ordinal numbers from the first to the tenth. Read them aloud and ask your learner to repeat. Then point to numbers at random and ask your learner to say the ordinal number.

Activity 2: talking about birthdays (10 minutes)

- Focus your learner's attention on photographs of celebrations from previous lessons. Wherever possible, elicit a date and a month.
- Show your learner the birthday photograph. Ask your learner questions, for example: 'What date is your birthday?' 'What season is it in?' 'What do you do on your birthday?' 'What do you eat?' 'What do you drink?' 'Do you go out?' 'Do you stay at home?' Generate as much language as possible and write it down for use in the language experience activity (see extension).
- If your learner has children he or she might prefer to speak about their birthdays instead.

Activity 3: writing an invitation (15 mins)

- Show your learner the party invitations you have collected and teach the word *invitation*.
- Ask your learner to read the invitations or to read them aloud after you, sentence by sentence. Highlight the key features:
 - the invitation is addressed to a person, and gives information about where and when the party will be
 - there is often an address and phone number included and a request to let the writer know if you can come
 - usually an invitation begins by stating the kind of party it will be.
- Present your learner with the writing frame (**Worksheet 7**). Work together to fill in the gaps on the invitation, giving your learner as much support as necessary. Your learner can fill in the invitation for his or her own party. Alternatively, the learner can complete the invitation for a party for his or her children.
- Read the completed invitation aloud, focusing the learner's attention on the following: '*on* + day of the week'; '*the* + date + *of* + month'.

Differentiation:

If learners are unable to complete the writing frame activity, you could try a language experience approach:

- ask your learner to tell you what he or she would like to write on the invitation
- write down what your learner says in large writing on paper
- once you have built up a text, ask your learner to read the text back to you
- cut the text up into sentences and see if your learner can put them in order
- cut each sentence up into separate words and see if your learner can recreate the sentences.

You can find more about the language experience approach in the teaching learners 1-1 CPD guide.

Learning check:

Monitor activity 3 to assess whether your learner is able to produce a written invitation.

Activity 4: invitation role play (10 mins)

- Explain that there are other ways you can invite people to a party. Elicit that it is also possible to invite people by telephone.
- Give your learner **Worksheet 9** (the role play script). Read it together, filling in the blanks, either with your learner details or with made-up details.
- When your learner seems confident, simulate a telephone call. You can do this at first by turning the chairs around (so you are no longer facing each other) or you can even attempt to phone each other from different rooms.
- Take the role of the person who is doing the inviting first of all. Then, swap roles. Prompt your learner whenever necessary.

Cooler

- Revise the language learned in the unit by looking through the pictures of celebrations and asking your learner to tell you what he or she remembers. Name a few celebrations and ask your learner to tell you the date and month on which they occur. Ask about birthdays of family members.

Extensions:

- Use the language generated in activity 2 (on the subject of birthdays) to form the basis of a writing activity. Form the words and phrases you wrote down at that time into sentences asking your learner to help you and/or provide more information.
- When you have a few (3 or 4) sentences ask your learner to read them. Cut the text into separate sentences. Shuffle the sentences. Ask your learner to put them in order and then read them again. Take one of the sentences and cut it up into separate words. Ask your learner to order the words correctly and then read the sentence. If your learner is more confident he or she could, of course, attempt to write this paragraph with a lot less support.
- Further material on celebrations can be found at:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/lesson-plans/weddings-uk>

Lesson 2a: Worksheet 1



Lesson 2a: Worksheet 2





Lesson 2a: Worksheet 3

January	February	March
-----------------------	------------------------	---------------------

April	May	June
July	August	September
October	November	December

Lesson 2a. Worksheet 4

	I eat roast turkey.
	I put presents under the tree.
	I watch TV with my family.
	I give presents to my family.
	In the morning, I go to church.
	I drink wine.
	I go for a walk.
	I play games with my family.

Lesson 2b. Worksheet 5



This is Yun. She is from China.



People celebrate Chinese New Year in January or February.

Lesson 2b: Worksheet 6



Where does Yun go?

She goes to the town centre.



What does she eat?

She eats dumplings



Does she give presents?

Yes, she does



What does she do?

She decorates the house.

Lesson 2c: Worksheet 7 Writing frame: birthday invitation

Hi __,

It's my birthday on the _____ of _____.

Can you come to my party?

I live at

____.

Please let me know if you can come. My phone number is __

Hope to see you there!

From

Lesson 2c: Worksheet 8 – Role play



Hi _____

How are you?

**I'm really well! I'm calling because it's my birthday on _____ of _____.
Would you like to come?**

Yes, I'd love to. What time is it.

It starts at 5 o'clock

What's your address?

I live at _____.

See you then!